RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

20 OCTOBER 2026

# Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 11:54 PM, Tuesday 20 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 351 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 63 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 13,111 minutes at 12:00 AM (no takeoffs or landings since 9 PM; last movement Saudia SV979 from Guangzhou landed at 7:51 PM); Dammam moving with no halt since 9 PM

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INCIDENT SUMMARY

## What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 13,111 minutes at 12:00 AM; no takeoffs or landings since 9 PM, last movement Saudia SV979 from Guangzhou landing at 7:51 PM**.
- 351 Tuesday Riyadh flights cancelled (59%), and NOTAM A3650/26 still requires prior GACA permission for every flight.
- No new attack on Saudi Arabia reported since 9 PM; the coalition released footage at 10:25 PM of striking the launcher behind Tuesday's Riyadh missile.
- Houthi media claim drone hits on Saudi soldiers in Jizan and Asir, unverified and with no Saudi comment.
- Dammam airport moving with no halt since 9 PM: 6 takeoffs and 9 landings, latest flynas XY421 from Jeddah landed at 11:44 PM.

**RIYADH AIRPORT** RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (13105 min).

| 351 | 0/0 | 8 |
|---|---|---|
| CANCELLED TODAY | TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H | DIVERTED |

**DAMMAM AIRPORT** DMM

DISRUPTED

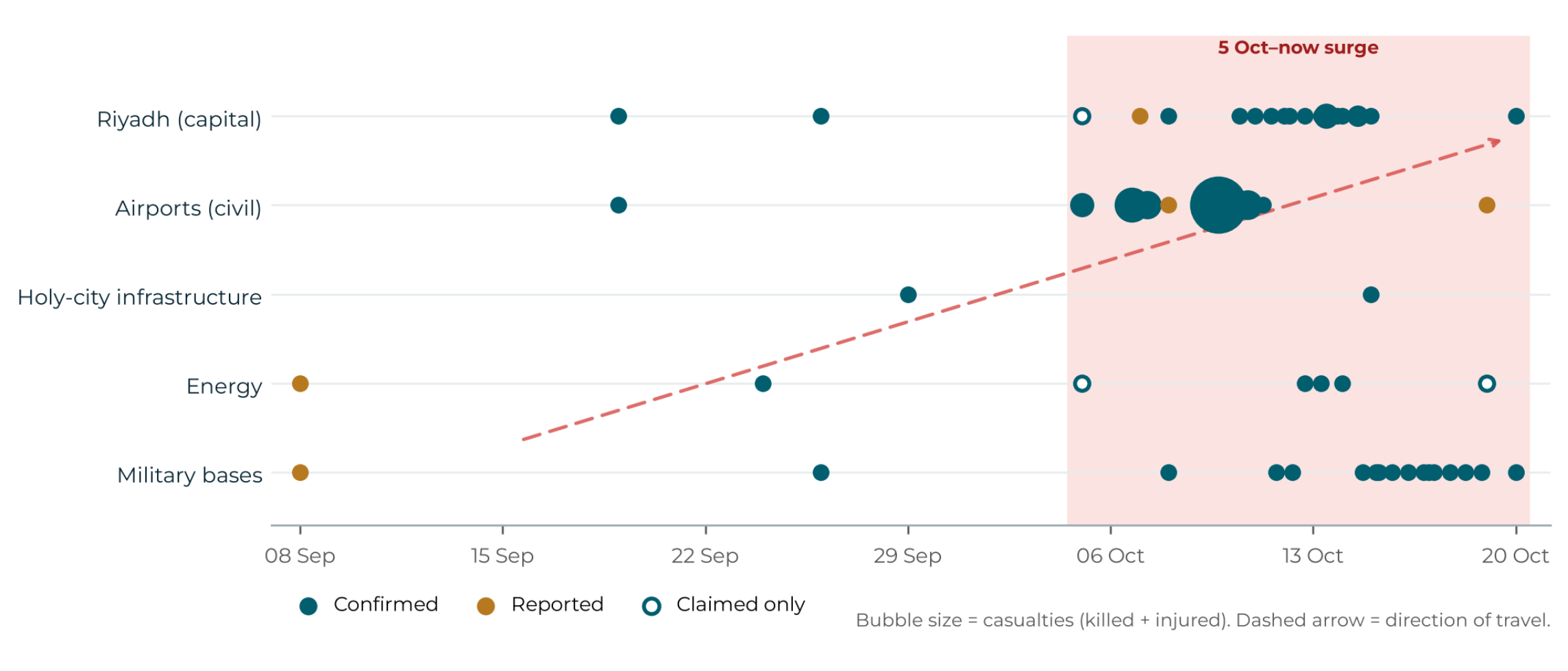
1 takeoff and 3 landings in the last hour.

| 63 | 1/3 | 0 |
|---|---|---|
| CANCELLED TODAY | TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H | DIVERTED |

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (13,111 min at 12:00 AM); no takeoffs or landings since 9 PM, last movement Saudia SV979 from Guangzhou at 7:51 PM
- Coalition releases footage of striking the launcher behind Tuesday's Riyadh missile (10:25 PM); no new attack on Saudi Arabia since 9 PM
- Houthi media claim drone hits on Saudi soldiers in Jizan and Asir (10:07 PM, unverified, no Saudi comment)
- Riyadh airport tells passengers to follow official authorities for airspace updates and contact their airline (9:33 PM)
- Dammam moving with no halt since 9 PM: 6 takeoffs and 9 landings, latest flynas XY421 from Jeddah at 11:44 PM

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 20 OCT



*54 sourced events since 8 September (46 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh region (20 Oct, Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA; none reported). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.*

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet’s Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam’s King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

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ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

## Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 9:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

**No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 9:00 PM AST.**

**Last 24 hours: Interceptions 3, alerts 1, all-clears 1.**

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NEWS AND STATEMENTS

## Coalition shows footage of striking the launcher behind Tuesday's Riyadh missile; Houthi media claim Jizan and Asir hits (unverified); Riyadh airport still halted

Checked at 11:58 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

UNVERIFIED **Footage circulating of travellers panicking at Riyadh airport after an explosion sound**

X account @Xnews_I · **11:22 PM** · posted 11:22 PM AST Tue 20 Oct; date and location of the video not verified, no official report of a new incident at the airport; checked 11:58 PM

An X account posted video it says shows panic among travellers at King Khalid International Airport after the sound of an explosion. The date of the footage is not confirmed and no Saudi authority has reported a new incident tonight.

CONFIRMED **Coalition releases footage of tracking and striking the launcher behind Tuesday's ballistic missile at Riyadh**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox); SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **10:25 PM** · published 10:25 PM AST (Arabic), SPA English 10:47 PM; also Al Ekhbariya 10:29 PM; checked 11:58 PM

The coalition published video it says shows its forces tracking and destroying the Houthi launch platform used for the ballistic missile fired at Riyadh on Tuesday, following its 8:06 PM statement.

CLAIM **Houthi media claim drone hits on Saudi soldiers in Jizan and Asir**

Houthi War Media video, reported on X (@realmaxmorgan) · **10:07 PM** · posted 10:07 PM AST Tue 20 Oct; not independently verified, no Saudi comment; checked 11:58 PM

Houthi War Media released a video it says shows drone strikes on Saudi soldiers in Jizan and Asir. Claims of 40+ killed are unverified and Saudi authorities have not commented.

CONFIRMED **Riyadh airport tells travellers to follow official authorities for airspace updates and contact their airline**

King Khalid Intl Airport (@KKIASA) · **9:33 PM** · published 9:33 PM AST (English reply), repeated in Arabic 10:52 PM; checked 11:58 PM

Replying to passengers, the airport's official account said that for the latest airspace updates they should follow the relevant official authorities and contact the airline they booked with. It gave no reopening date.

UNVERIFIED **Islamic foreign ministers condemn Houthi aggression on Saudi Arabia**

Saudi Gazette (@Saudi_Gazette) · **8:30 PM** · published 8:30 PM AST Tue 20 Oct; single newspaper report, statement text not yet checked; checked 8:53 PM

Saudi Gazette reports that foreign ministers of Islamic countries condemned the Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia.

CONFIRMED **Saudi and Kuwaiti foreign ministers condemn continuing Houthi attacks on civilian areas in the Kingdom**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **8:22 PM** · published 8:22 PM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, translated from Arabic); checked 8:53 PM

SPA says the Saudi Foreign Minister and Kuwait's Foreign Minister discussed regional developments by phone and condemned the continuing attacks by the Houthi militia on civilian areas in the Kingdom, stressing the two countries' solidarity.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: launcher used for today's ballistic missile attack on Riyadh destroyed**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox); SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **8:06 PM** · published 8:06 PM AST (Arabic), SPA English 8:20 PM; also Al Ekhbariya, Arab News, Saudi Gazette; checked 8:53 PM

The coalition says it destroyed the platform the Houthi militia used to launch the ballistic missile fired at Riyadh earlier on Tuesday, which was intercepted at 11:39 AM.

CORROBORATED **Flightradar24: Riyadh airport open with prior permission, but no passenger flight has sought it**

Flightradar24 (@flightradar24) · **6:26 PM** · published 6:26 PM AST; matches the Riyadh board (only private, cargo-series and diverted traffic); checked 8:53 PM

Flightradar24 says Riyadh airport is open to traffic with prior permission, but no passenger flight has sought that permission so far, and only private and cargo flights have operated since the reopening.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh region**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox); SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **5:22 PM** · published 5:22 PM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); SPA Arabic 5:24 PM, SPA English 5:31 PM, Al Ekhbariya 5:25 PM; checked 5:55 PM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki said a drone was intercepted and destroyed in the Riyadh region. It is the second Riyadh-area intercept today after the 11:39 AM ballistic missile. No debris, damage or casualties have been reported, and no Civil Defense alert for it appeared on the official account.

CORROBORATED **Reuters: most Gulf stock markets slip after new Houthi claims against Saudi energy and airport sites**

Reuters (@Reuters) · **4:10 PM** · posted 4:10 PM AST Tue 20 Oct; checked 5:55 PM; the Houthi claims themselves are not confirmed by Saudi authorities; Reuters updated the story at 8:20 PM AST

Reuters reported that most Gulf bourses retreated on Tuesday after the Houthis claimed operations against Saudi energy and airport sites. Saudi authorities have not confirmed those claims.

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KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

## Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (13105 min).

| 351 | 5:36 PM | 7:51 PM | 0 | 8 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY | LAST TAKEOFF | LAST LANDING | TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR | ARRIVALS DIVERTED |
| 174 departures + 177 arrivals, 59% of 593 scheduled. | OS2828 to Milan, 377 min before 11:54 PM. | SV979 from Guangzhou, 242 min before 11:54 PM. | 0 landings in the last hour. | Mostly to Jeddah, Dammam, Qassim. |

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 11:54 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 338 at 11:54 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

| MEASURE | DEPARTURES | ARRIVALS | TOTAL | BASIS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cancelled today, board count | 174 | 177 | 351 | FR24 boards, local day |
| Cancelled today, stats panel | 164 (54%) | 174 (59%) | 338 | FR24 stats panel |
| Delayed today | 4 (1%) | 1 (0%) | 5 | FR24 stats panel |
| On time today (share of operated) | 3 (43%) | 5 (83%) | 8 | FR24 stats panel |
| Average delay, recent flights | 305 min | 0 min | — | FR24 stats panel |
| Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far | 2 of 299 | 1 of 291 | 3 of 590 | FR24 boards |
| Diverted today | — | 8 | 8 | FR24 arrivals board |
| Already cancelled tomorrow | 30 | 38 | 68 | FR24 stats panel |
| Cancelled yesterday (for scale) | 72 | 100 | 172 | FR24 stats panel |

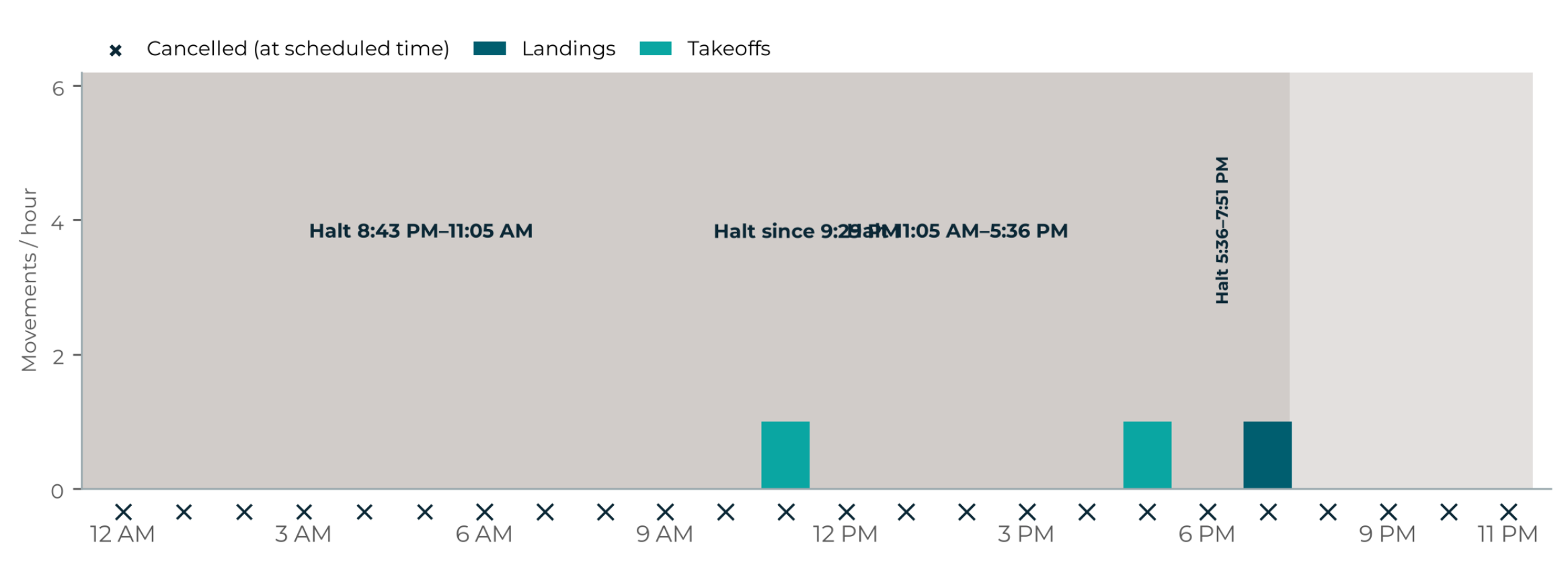
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

| | |
|---|---|
| Saudia | 223 |
| flynas | 51 |
| flyadeal | 21 |
| Gulf Air | 8 |
| Emirates | 6 |

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

| | |
|---|---|
| Jeddah | 65 |
| Madinah | 31 |
| Dammam | 29 |
| Dubai | 26 |
| Abha | 21 |

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



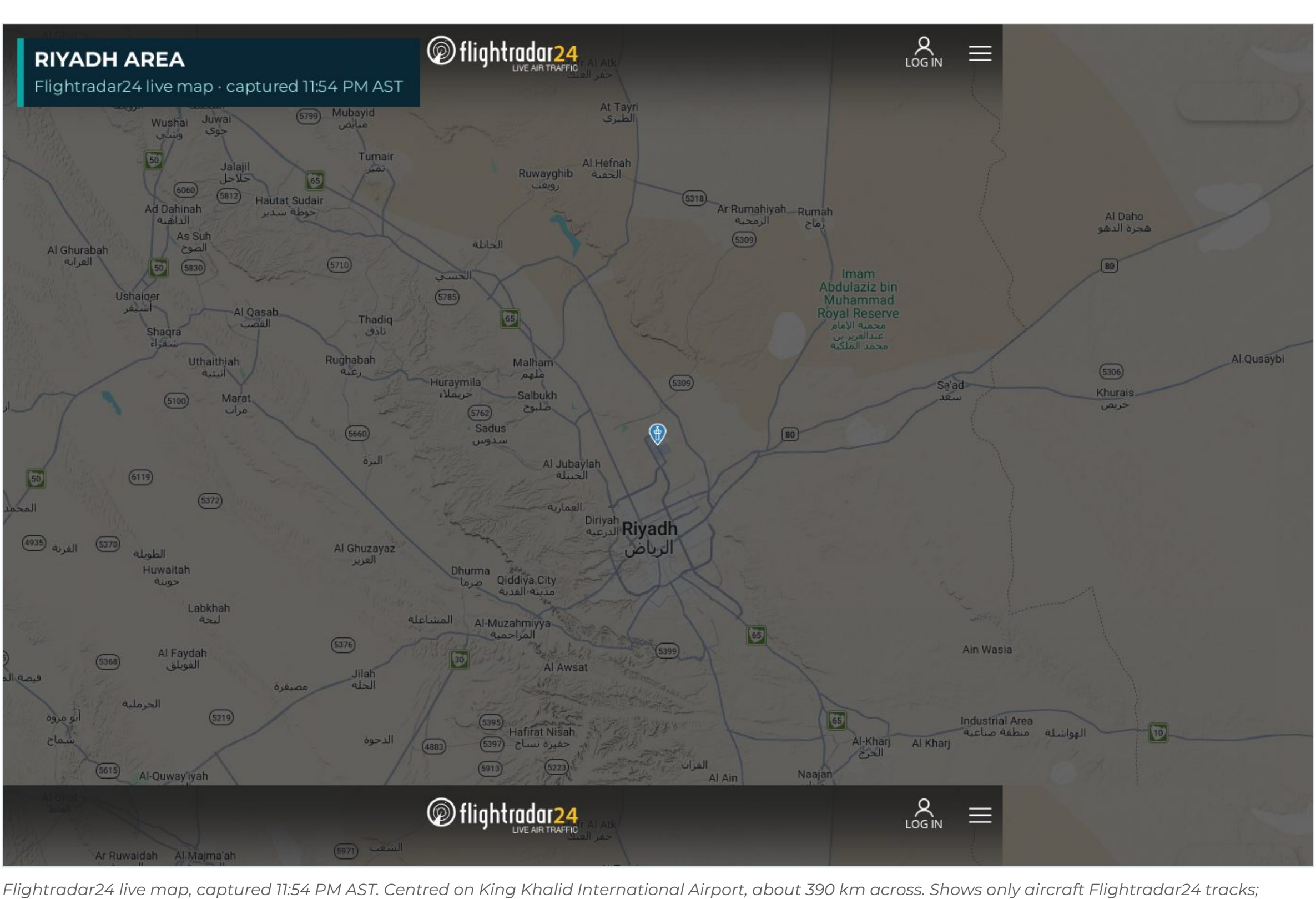
*Recorded takeoffs (2) and landings (1) at RUH per hour from 12:00 AM Tuesday to 11:54 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.*

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh’s open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are non-scheduled flights: landings SV918 at 4:27 PM and N437GA at 8:43 PM Monday, and the private-jet takeoff HZSK5 to Geneva at 11:05 AM Tuesday. Dammam’s halts in the window ran 12:41–1:48 AM, 2:04–2:53 AM, 5:15–6:17 AM and 7:13–8:11 AM Tuesday; Dammam has had no halt since 8:11 AM; its longest gap since 12:00 PM was 17 minutes.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

| | |
|---|---|
| **Halt 5:36–7:51 PM** | 135 min |
| **Halt 11:05 AM–5:36 PM** | 391 min |
| **Halt 8:43 PM–11:05 AM** | 862 min |
| **OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM** | 13105 min and counting |

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



*Flightradar24 live map, captured 11:54 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.*

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KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

## Dammam airport: disrupted. 1 takeoff and 3 landings in the last hour.

| 63 | 11:16 PM | 11:44 PM | 1 | 0 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY | LAST TAKEOFF | LAST LANDING | TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR | ARRIVALS DIVERTED |
| 31 departures + 32 arrivals, 29% of 220 scheduled. | NE151 to Cairo, 37 min before 11:54 PM. | XY421 from Jeddah, 10 min before 11:54 PM. | 3 landings in the last hour. | None recorded today. |

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 11:54 PM. Flightradar24’s own stats panel shows 60 at 11:54 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

| MEASURE | DEPARTURES | ARRIVALS | TOTAL | BASIS |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cancelled today, board count | 31 | 32 | 63 | FR24 boards, local day |
| Cancelled today, stats panel | 29 (26%) | 31 (29%) | 60 | FR24 stats panel |
| Delayed today | 34 (30%) | 16 (15%) | 50 | FR24 stats panel |
| On time today (share of operated) | 29 (46%) | 44 (73%) | 73 | FR24 stats panel |
| Average delay, recent flights | 48 min | 10 min | — | FR24 stats panel |
| Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far | 62 of 112 | 53 of 106 | 115 of 218 | FR24 boards |
| Diverted today | — | 0 | 0 | FR24 arrivals board |
| Already cancelled tomorrow | 13 | 18 | 31 | FR24 stats panel |
| Cancelled yesterday (for scale) | 15 | 18 | 33 | FR24 stats panel |

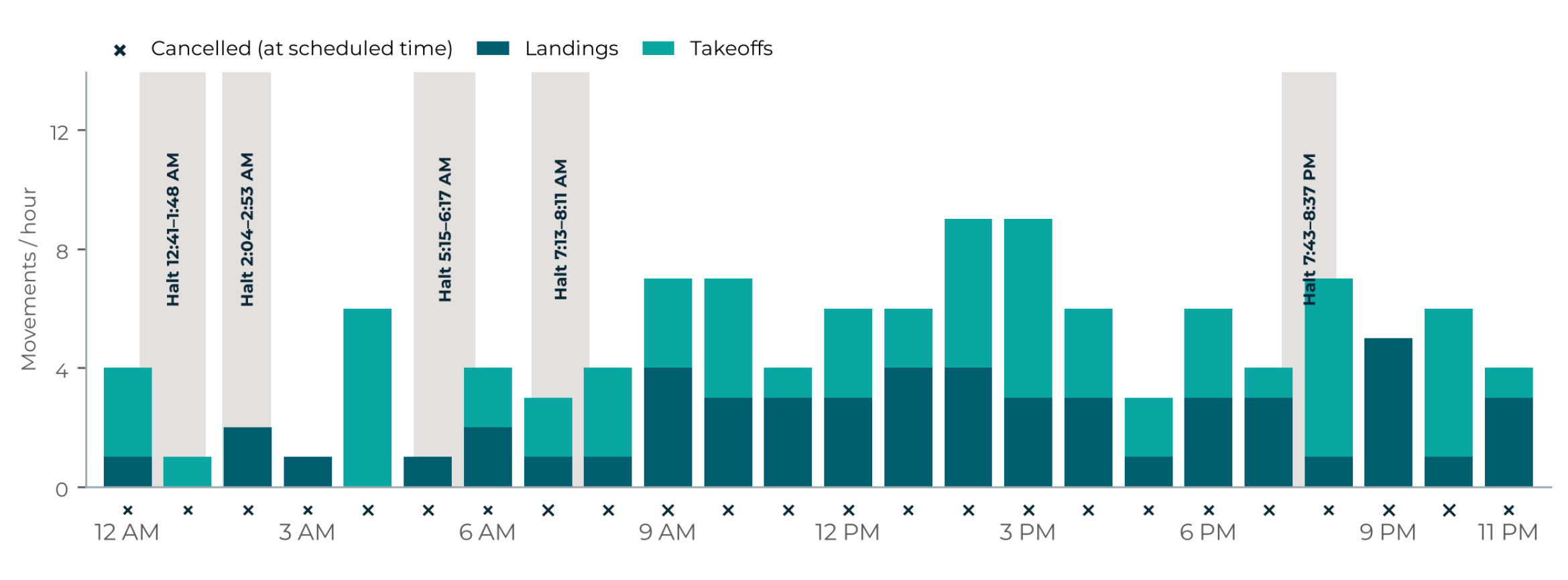
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

| | |
|---|---|
| Saudia | 24 |
| flydubai | 8 |
| Egyptair | 6 |
| Emirates | 6 |
| Etihad Airways | 6 |

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

| | |
|---|---|
| Riyadh | 29 |
| Dubai | 14 |
| Cairo | 6 |
| Abu Dhabi | 6 |
| Madinah | 4 |

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



*Recorded takeoffs (62) and landings (53) at DMM per hour from 12:00 AM Tuesday to 11:54 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.*

Moving, no open halt at 12:00 AM: 6 takeoffs and 9 landings since 9 PM, 1 takeoff and 3 landings in the last hour.

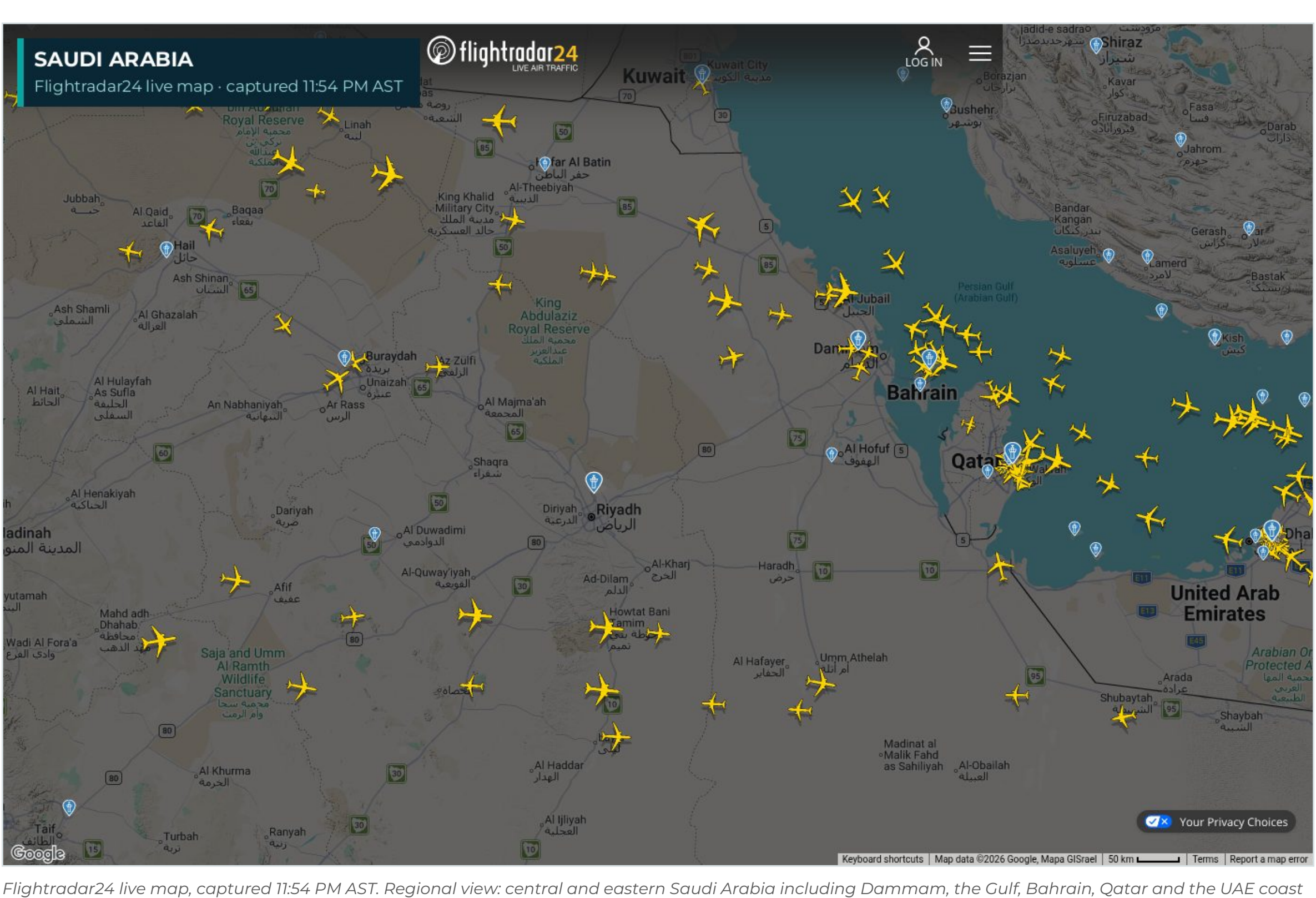
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

| | |
|---|---|
| **Halt 7:43–8:37 PM** | 54 min |
| **Halt 7:13–8:11 AM** | 58 min |
| **Halt 5:15–6:17 AM** | 62 min |
| **Halt 2:04–2:53 AM** | 49 min |
| **Halt 12:41–1:48 AM** | 66 min |

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition’s news check (11:58 PM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



*Flightradar24 live map, captured 11:54 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.*

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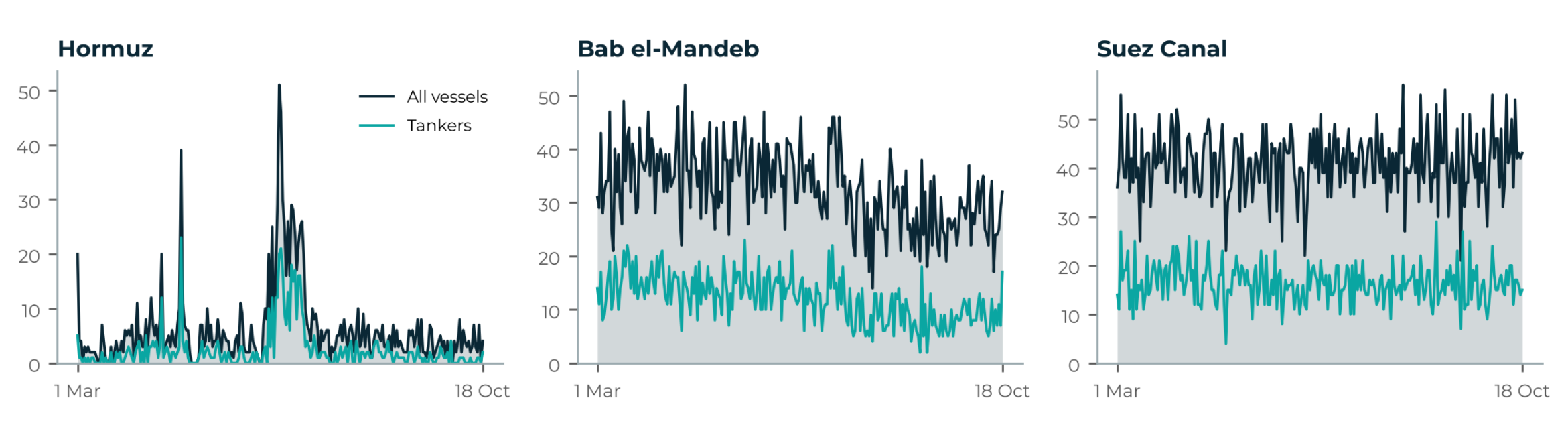
ECONOMY

## Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

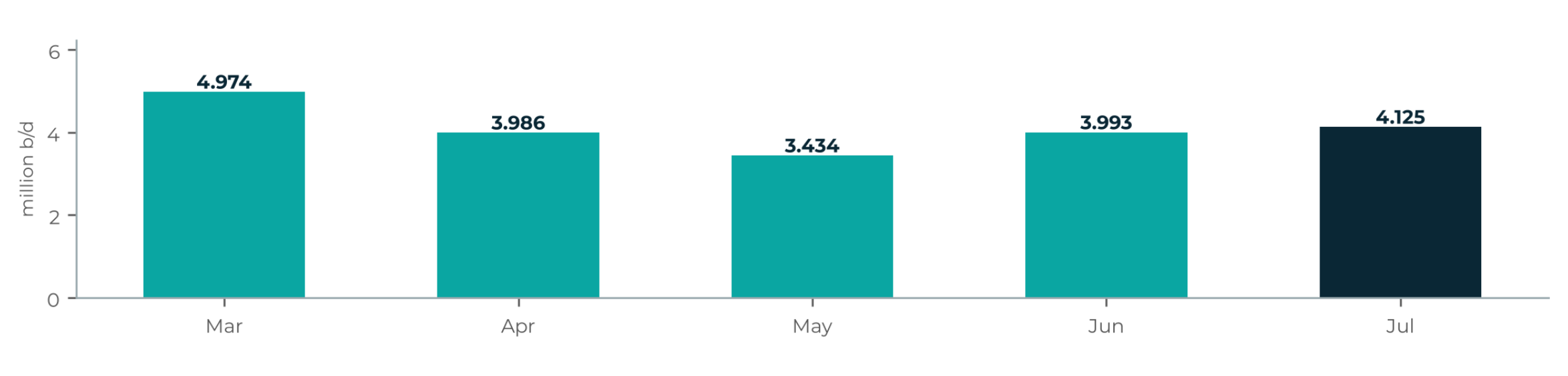
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

| CHOKEPOINT | LATEST DAY | ALL VESSELS | TANKERS | OTHER SHIPS | 7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Hormuz** | Sun 18 Oct | **4** | 2 | 2 | 3.7 (4.1) |
| **Bab el-Mandeb** | Sun 18 Oct | **32** | 17 | 15 | 26.4 (28.3) |
| **Suez Canal** | Sun 18 Oct | **43** | 15 | 28 | 44.3 (41.7) |



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 11:55 PM, Tue 20 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

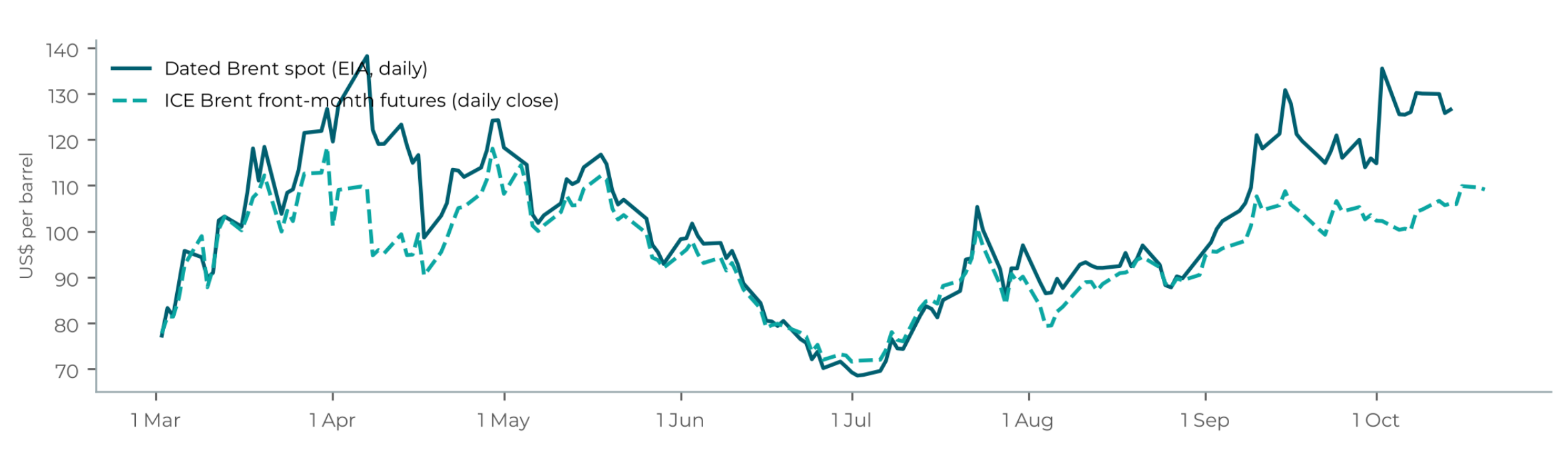


**Monthly, lagged about two months.** Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

*Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).*

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

| $109.10 | $126.55 | +4% | +64% |
|---|---|---|---|
| BRENT FUTURES, LATEST | DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA) | SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE | SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH |
| ICE front-month, 11:44 PM, Tue 20 Oct AST (-0.4% on day). Near real time. | Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days. | From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep. | From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr. |



*Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday’s close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.*

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METHOD AND LIMITS

## What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 11:54 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam’s status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

| PREPARED | BOARD DATA AS OF | SOURCES | STATUS | HANDLING | NEXT UPDATE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 11:54 PM, Tue 20 Oct | 11:54 PM | Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA | **RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted** | Open sources · not official | 3:00 AM |

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 3:00 AM